

I know who your name, where you work, and live (Safari v4 & v5)

I know who your name, where you work, and live (Safari v4 & v5) - Author not stated, jeremiahgrossman.blogspot.com.

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Content

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Update 07.30.2010: Apple patched Safari ([CVE-ID: CVE-2010-1796](#))

Right at the moment a Safari user visits a website, even if they've never been there before or entered any personal information, a malicious website can uncover their first name, last name, work place, city, state, and email address. Safari v4 & v5, with a [combined market browser share of 4%](#) (~83 million users), has a feature (Preferences > AutoFill > AutoFill web forms) enabled by default. Essentially we are hacking auto-complete functionality.

! This feature AutoFill's HTML form text fields that have specific attribute names such as name, company, city, state, country, email, etc.

```
!<* form> <* input type="text" name="name"> <* input type="text" name="company"> <* input type="text" name="city"> <* input type="text" name="state"> <* input type="text" name="country"> <* input type="text" name="email"> <* /form>
```

These fields are AutoFill'ed using data from the users personal record in the local operating system address book. Again it is important to emphasize this feature works even though a user never entered this data on any website. Also this behavior should not be confused with normal auto-complete data a Web browser may remember after its typed into a form.

!All a malicious website would have to do to surreptitiously extract Address Book card data from Safari is dynamically create form text fields with the aforementioned names, probably invisibly, and then simulate A-Z keystroke events using JavaScript. When data is populated, that is AutoFill'ed, it can be accessed and sent to the attacker.

As shown in the [proof-of-concept code](#) (graciously hosted by [Robert "RSnake" Hansen](#)), the entire process takes mere seconds and represents a major breach in online privacy. This attack could be further leveraged in multistage attacks including email spam, (spear) phishing, stalking, and even blackmail if a user is de-anonymized while visiting objectionable online material.

Fortunately any AutoFill data starting with a number, such as phone numbers or street addresses, could not be obtained because for some reason the data would not populate in the text field. Still, such attacks could be easily and cheaply distributed on a mass scale using an advertising network where likely no one would ever notice because it's not exploit code designed to deliver rootkit payload. In fact, there is no guarantee this has not already taken place. What is safe to say is that this vulnerability is so brain dead simple that I assumed someone else must have publicly reported it already, but exhaustive searches and asking several colleagues turned up nothing.

I figured Apple might appreciate a vulnerability disclosure prior to public discussion, which I did on June 17, 2010 complete with technical detail. A gleeful auto-response came shortly after, to which I replied asking if Apple was already aware of the issue. I received no response after that, human or robot. I have no idea when or if Apple plans to fix the issue, or even if they are aware, but thankfully Safari users only need to disable AutoFill web forms to protect themselves.

Video Demo

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